

Problem 1. Abawiri Answers and Explanation (1/2)

Total: 16 points

Problem 1. Abawiri

1.1	a <i>the chicken's fish</i>	1.2	[wùtù βògèi]
	b <i>the bird's rat</i>		[bògèi sòkrè]
	c <i>the chicken's frog</i>		[bórú dèβi]

1.3	a [bògèi βórú]	f [g ^w ákú g ^w ákù]
	b [sòrí dèβi]	g [àjá sòrì]
	c [bórú àjà]	h [sòkrē dúkè]
	d [sòrì sòkrè]	i [wùtù dúkè]
	e [sòkrè àjà]	j [wùtú dèβi]

Q 1.1 Max 3. 1pt if correct.

Q 1.2 Max 3. 1pt if correct.

Q 1.3 Max 10. 1pt if correct. Do not penalise **o**, **e** for **ɔ**, **ɛ**, but require **b** vs **β**.

Problem 1. Abawiri Explanation (2/2)

Explanation

- Word order is possessor-possessed
- **b** > **β** after a vowel

The most accurate general analysis is as follows:

- Words have a lexical tone, either high (H), low (L) or toneless (0)
 - H = {bɔru, g^waku, duke}, L = {deβi, sɔri, wutu}, 0 = {bɔgei, aja, sɔkre}
 - H words take high tone on their first syllable; L and 0 take low tone on their first syllable
 - The final syllable of a phrase is low
- The tone of the second syllable is established as follows:
 - Before L, the previous syllable is high (*anticipatory tonal polarity*)
 - Before H, the final syllable of a 0 word becomes mid (*gradual updrift*)
 - If neither of the previous apply, then the word's first syllable tone spreads to its second syllable tone (toneless taking a default low-low).

An alternative analysis of the tone that works for this problem is as follows:

- There are three classes of word – call them H, L, 0 as before.
 - H has tone pattern $\acute{V}\acute{V}$ when the first word, and $\acute{V}\grave{V}$ when second.
 - L has pattern $\grave{V}\acute{V}$ before another L, and else is $\grave{V}\grave{V}$.
 - 0 has pattern $\grave{V}\acute{V}$ before L, $\grave{V}\bar{V}$ before H, and else is $\grave{V}\grave{V}$.

Notes:

- This problem demonstrates only a very small piece of the Abawiri tone system. In Abawiri, there are many more lexical tone categories than these three, and words with different numbers of syllables fall into each one. There are also grammatical tone rules in some limited contexts. The rule that the last syllable in a phrase/utterance is low always applies, as does gradual updrift. Anticipatory tonal polarity applies except in some specific syntactic contexts.
- None of the tone rules shown in this problem are specific to the genitive construction, which is a simple juxtaposition of possessor-possessed

Source: <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/4mj571tr>

Yoder, Brendon Eugene. A grammar of Abawiri, a Lakes Plain language of Papua, Indonesia. 2020. Especially, pp. 65 ff. for tone analysis/data and p. 111 for genitive construction.